

Charles Harless
Software Engineering Manager

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Engineering Leadership | Streaming Media | Web & Mobile Applications

Professional Summary

Software Engineering Manager with experience leading and scaling engineering teams in large, complex organizations. Managed engineering teams ranging from 7 to 15 engineers across web and mobile platforms, with responsibility for delivery, reliability, and performance of business-critical systems. Improved delivery predictability and modernized platforms while maintaining a sustainable development pace. Domain expert in streaming media, distributed systems, and AWS-based architectures. Partners with product and stakeholders to align technical execution with business goals.

- **Scaled Impact:** Launched Disney Movies Anywhere with 20M+ users on web & mobile platforms
- **Engineering Leadership:** Led multi-team organizations delivering high-traffic applications
- **Delivery Excellence:** Reduced engineering backlog by up to 75%, improving release cadence
- **Operational Efficiency:** Drove 15% infrastructure cost reduction through automation
- **Workplace Culture:** Improved team morale by 40-50% through coaching and recognition.
- **Reliability at Scale:** Maintained 99.9% uptime for distributed backend services and APIs

Experience

Software Engineering Manager
Thinking Bear Consulting, Los Angeles, CA
09/2023 - Present

- Owned delivery and technical direction for high-traffic AWS-hosted web applications
- Translated business goals into execution plans and technical roadmaps
- Improved scalability and performance by 15% through architectural refinements and tuning
- Reduced infrastructure costs by 15% through automation, governance controls, and metrics

Software Engineering Manager
Brightcove, Boston, MA
01/2023 - 06/2023

- Managed 14 engineers across 2 teams building AWS-based media and web applications
- Partnered with product and design leadership to realign roadmaps and improve delivery
- Increased release frequency by 20% through process improvements and automation
- Reduced engineering backlog by 75% using capacity planning and prioritization
- Improved developer engagement by 40% through individualized growth plans and mentoring

Software Development Manager
Amazon Prime Video, Culver City, CA
01/2021 - 06/2022

- Managed 7 engineers delivering media workflows integrated with 25+ backend services
- Owned delivery for systems in critical media pipelines, maintaining speed, quality, and stability
- Reduced time-to-market by 15% through iterative delivery, delegation, and accountability
- Coordinated security updates across 2,000+ applications, achieving 100% compliance in 1 week
- Established development programs that increased team morale and engagement by 50%

Technical Lead
NBCUniversal, Universal City, CA
04/2016 - 12/2020

- Defined architectural vision for enterprise platforms supporting 23,000+ internal users
- Led cross-functional teams modernizing legacy portals, increasing workforce productivity by 10%
- Introduced coding standards, improving release quality and reliability by 15%

Technical Lead

Walt Disney Studios, Burbank, CA

11/2011 - 04/2015

- Launched Disney Movies Anywhere, supporting 20M+ users with 99.9% uptime
- Led cross-functional team of 15 people building multi-platform streaming applications using Java
- Designed and implemented high-availability REST APIs handling millions of daily transactions
- Partnered closely with Product and Operations teams to improve reliability and performance

Senior Software Engineer & Architect

Walt Disney Parks & Resorts, Glendale, CA

12/2005 - 10/2011

- Standardized application architecture, improving platform scalability by 20%
- Designed semantic data models that improved reuse and system integration across systems

Teaching

Computer Science Instructor

UCLA Extension - Los Angeles, CA

August 2015 - Present

- Instructed Java, Web Applications, and Data Structures courses
- Earned a 4.7/5.0 instructor rating through clear explanations and real-world examples
- Developed project-based curriculum increasing student engagement by ~20%

Education

- Master of Science Degree, Computer Science, University of California Los Angeles
- Bachelor of Science Degree, Computer Science, University of Alabama

Certifications

- Certified ScrumMaster, Scrum Alliance
- Certified Scrum Product Owner, Scrum Alliance
- Generative AI Fundamentals Certificate, Databricks

Skills

- **People Leadership & Execution:** Engineering Management, Team Building, Mentorship & Career Development, Performance Management, Roadmap Planning, Agile Development
- **Organizational & Operational Leadership:** Cross-Functional Collaboration, Stakeholder Management, Incident Management, Capacity Planning, Delivery Predictability
- **Architecture & Systems:** AWS, Distributed Systems, System Design, Scalability & Performance, Microservices, Web Services & REST APIs, CI/CD Pipelines
- **Languages & Tools:** Java, Spring, Node.js, JavaScript/TypeScript, MongoDB, MySQL, GitHub